

0.0.1 The Great References

1. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling in Bhoganagara at the Ananda shrine. At that place the Auspicious One addressed the bhikkhus. “Bhikkhus.” “Yes Bhante.” Those bhikkhus replied to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

2. “O bhikkhus, I will teach you these four great references. Listen to that and do mind it well, I will speak.” “Yes Bhante,” those bhikkhus replied to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this: And what, O bhikkhus, are the four great references?

3. “Here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu might say thus: “O friends, in the presence of the Auspicious One, this was heard by me, this was received in his presence. This is the Dhamma, this is the Vinaya, this is the Teacher’s instructions.” For him, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu’s words should simply not be delighted in, should not be rejected. Not having delighted in, not having rejected, having thoroughly learned his words and phrases, those [words and phrases] should be descended into the suttas, pointed out in the Vinaya. If those are being made to fit in with the suttas, those are being pointed out in the Vinaya, but cannot even descend into the suttas, cannot be pointed out in the vinaya, then you must reach this conclusion here: Certainly, this is just not the words of the Auspicious One, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. This

bhikkhu has learned them incorrectly. Thus, O bhikkhus, this must be discarded by you.

4. Or else here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu might say thus: “O friends, in the presence of the Auspicious One, this was heard by me, this was received in his presence. This is the Dhamma, this is the Vinaya, this is the Teacher’s instructions.” For him, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu’s words should simply not be delighted in, should not be rejected. Not having delighted in, not having rejected, having thoroughly learned his words and phrases, those [words and phrases] should be descended into the suttas, pointed out in the Vinaya. If those are being made to fit in with the suttas, those are being pointed out in the Vinaya, and can just descend into the suttas, can be pointed out in the vinaya, then you must reach this conclusion here: Certainly, this is just the words of the Auspicious One, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. This bhikkhu has learned them correctly. This, O bhikkhus, is the first great reference that you should bear in mind.

5. Or else here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu might say thus: “Indeed in such and such dwelling place, a sangha dwells with an eminent elder. In the presence of that Sangha, this was heard by me, this was received in their presence. This is the Dhamma, this is the Vinaya, this is the Teacher’s instructions.” For him, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu’s words should simply not be delighted in, should not be rejected. Not having delighted in, not having re-

jected, having thoroughly learned his words and phrases, those [words and phrases] should be descended into the suttas, pointed out in the Vinaya. If those are being made to fit in with the suttas, those are being pointed out in the Vinaya, but cannot even descend into the suttas, cannot be pointed out in the vinaya, then you must reach this conclusion here: Certainly, this is just not the words of the Auspicious One, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. This bhikkhu has learned them incorrectly. Thus, O bhikkhus, this must be discarded by you.

6. Or else here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu might say thus: “Indeed in such and such dwelling place, a sangha dwells with an eminent elder. In the presence of that Sangha, this was heard by me, this was received in their presence. This is the Dhamma, this is the Vinaya, this is the Teacher’s instructions.” For him, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu’s words should simply not be delighted in, should not be rejected. Not having delighted in, not having rejected, having thoroughly learned his words and phrases, those [words and phrases] should be descended into the suttas, pointed out in the Vinaya. If those are being made to fit in with the suttas, those are being pointed out in the Vinaya, and can just descend into the suttas, can be pointed out in the Vinaya, then you must reach this conclusion here: Certainly, this is just the words of the Auspicious One, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. This bhikkhu has learned them correctly. This, O

bhikkhus, is the second great reference that you should bear in mind.

7. Or else here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu might say thus: “Indeed in such and such dwelling place, many elder bhikkhus dwell, who are well-learned, experts on the discourses, bearers of the Dhamma, bearers of the Vinaya, bearers of the outlines. In the presence of those elders, this was heard by me, this was received in their presence. This is the Dhamma, this is the Vinaya, this is the Teacher’s instructions.” For him, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu’s words should simply not be delighted in, should not be rejected. Not having delighted in, not having rejected, having thoroughly learned his words and phrases, those [words and phrases] should be descended into the suttas, pointed out in the Vinaya. If those are being made to fit in with the suttas, those are being pointed out in the Vinaya, but cannot even descend into the suttas, cannot be pointed out in the vinaya, then you must reach this conclusion here: Certainly, this is just not the words of the Auspicious One, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. This bhikkhu has learned them incorrectly. Thus, O bhikkhus, this must be discarded by you.

8. Or else here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu might say thus: “Indeed in such and such dwelling place, many elder bhikkhus dwell, who are well-learned, experts on the discourses, bearers of the Dhamma, bearers of the Vinaya,

bearers of the outlines. In the presence of those elders, this was heard by me, this was received in their presence. This is the Dhamma, this is the Vinaya, this is the Teacher's instructions." For him, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu's words should simply not be delighted in, should not be rejected. Not having delighted in, not having rejected, having thoroughly learned his words and phrases, those [words and phrases] should be descended into the suttas, pointed out in the Vinaya. If those are being made to fit in with the suttas, those are being pointed out in the Vinaya, and can just descend into the suttas, can be pointed out in the vinaya, then you must reach this conclusion here: Certainly, this is just the words of the Auspicious One, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. This bhikkhu has learned them correctly. This, O bhikkhus, is the third great reference that you should bear in mind.

9. Or else here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu might say thus: "Indeed in such and such dwelling place, one elder bhikkhu dwells, who is well-learned, expert on the discourses, bearer of the Dhamma, bearer of the Vinaya, bearer of the outlines. In the presence of that elder, this was heard by me, this was received in his presence. This is the Dhamma, this is the Vinaya, this is the Teacher's instructions." For him, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu's words should simply not be delighted in, should not be rejected. Not having delighted in, not having rejected, having thoroughly learned his words and phrases, those [words and

phrases] should be descended into the suttas, pointed out in the Vinaya. If those are being made to fit in with the suttas, those are being pointed out in the Vinaya, but cannot even descend into the suttas, cannot be pointed out in the vinaya, then you must reach this conclusion here: Certainly, this is just not the words of the Auspicious One, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. This bhikkhu has learned them incorrectly. Thus, O bhikkhus, this must be discarded by you.

10. Or else here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu might say thus: “Indeed in such and such dwelling place, one elder bhikkhu dwells, who is well-learned, expert on the discourses, bearer of the Dhamma, bearer of the Vinaya, bearer of the outlines. In the presence of that elder, this was heard by me, this was received in his presence. This is the Dhamma, this is the Vinaya, this is the Teacher’s instructions.” For him, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu’s words should simply not be delighted in, should not be rejected. Not having delighted in, not having rejected, having thoroughly learned his words and phrases, those [words and phrases] should be descended into the suttas, pointed out in the Vinaya. If those are being made to fit in with the suttas, those are being pointed out in the Vinaya, and can just descend into the suttas, can be pointed out in the Vinaya, then you must reach this conclusion here: Certainly, this is just the words of the Auspicious One, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one. This bhikkhu has learned them correctly. This, O bhikkhus, is the

fourth great reference that you should bear in mind.

11. These, O bhikkhus, are the four great references.”